



HOW FORMULA 1 BECAME A FASHION LUXURY BRAND

The evolution of F1 beyond motorsport



THE SHIFT FROM RACETRACK TO RUNWAY

Formula 1 was once positioned primarily as a technical motorsport. Today, the paddock has become a cultural space where sportswear, streetwear, luxury and celebrity intersect. The transformation is not about changing the race itself. It is about changing how F1 is presented, consumed and branded.



THE PADDOCK'S NEW WARDROBE

Team clothing used to function mainly as uniform and merchandise. Now, apparel has become part of a team's visual identity and cultural positioning.

Brands are choosing partners with fashion credibility moving beyond traditional motorsport suppliers.



EXAMPLES

McLAREN × PUMA

A move towards performance + lifestyle.

MERCEDES × ADIDAS

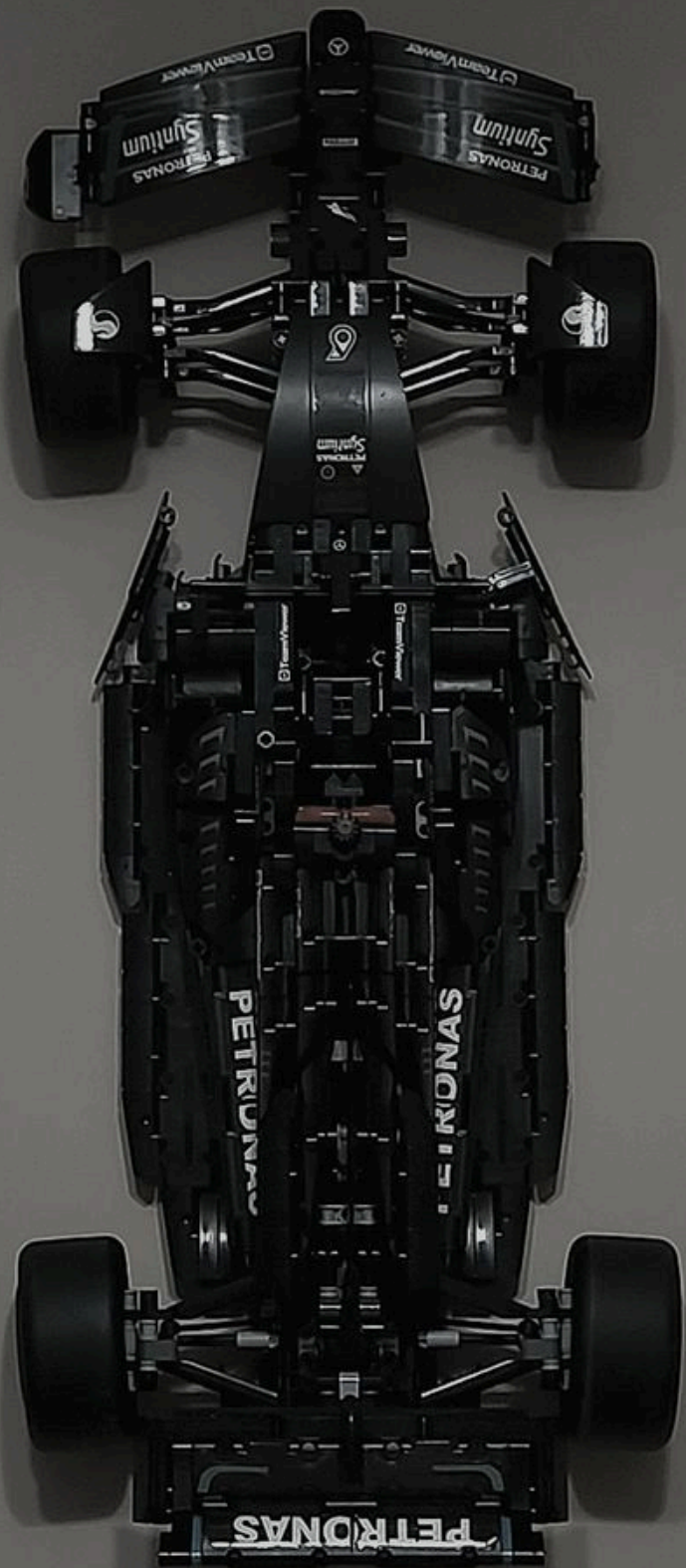
A full teamwear programme bringing global sportswear credibility into F1.

HAAS × PALM ANGELS

A direct connection between F1 and contemporary streetwear.

WILLIAMS × NEW ERA

A lifestyle-first approach built around pieces such as hoodies and varsity jackets.



THE MERCH ECONOMY FROM FAN GEAR TO FASHION GOODS



F1 merchandise is no longer simply something fans buy to support a team. It has become part of the wider fashion and lifestyle economy surrounding the sport. As F1's audience expanded, merchandise became a way to participate in the culture even without being a traditional motorsport fan.

THE BUSINESS OPPORTUNITY MERCHANDISING

Creates new revenue beyond tickets and broadcasting.

LICENSING

Allows F1 teams and drivers to extend their brands into consumer products.

CULTURAL VALUE

Turns team logos and colours into lifestyle symbols.



THE DRIVER BECOMES THE BRAND

The fashion opportunity does not stop with the team.

F1 drivers have increasingly become personal brands, with identities that exist beyond the racetrack.

LEWIS HAMILTON

Hamilton represents one of the strongest examples of the crossover between

SPORT × FASHION × MUSIC × ART × LUXURY

His fashion positioning includes collaborations and partnerships that extend his identity beyond being an F1 driver.

This changes the traditional sponsorship model

Driver + Sponsor

becomes

Driver + Personal Identity + Cultural Influence



VICTORY TRAVELS IN
LOUIS VUITTON

WHEN LUXURY STARTED RACING

The strongest signal of F1's changing position is the arrival of major luxury groups.

LVMH × FORMULA 1

A 10-year global partnership beginning in 2025 brought brands including:

LOUIS VUITTON

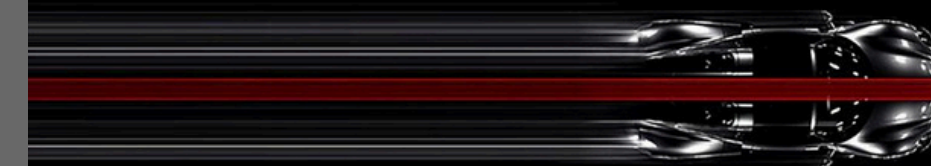
TAG HEUER

MOËT HENNESSY

Louis Vuitton's involvement in trophy presentation and TAG Heuer's association with F1 demonstrate how luxury brands can use the sport as a platform for heritage, prestige, craftsmanship and global visibility.

THE BIGGER STORY

***F1 is no longer simply sponsored by luxury.
It is increasingly becoming part of the luxury brand
ecosystem.***



THE DRIVE TO SURVIVE EFFECT

Why did this transformation happen now?

One major catalyst was Netflix's Drive to Survive.

The series introduced F1 to audiences who may never previously have followed motorsport.

NEW AUDIENCE

YOUNGER

MORE GLOBAL

MORE CULTURALLY ENGAGED

MORE FASHION-AWARE

At the same time, races in cities such as Miami and Las Vegas placed F1 directly inside global entertainment, luxury and lifestyle culture.

THE RESULT

F1 became more than something people watched.

It became something people could wear, follow, photograph, post and identify with.

HOW F1 BUILT A FASHION ECOSYSTEM

01 — TEAM APPAREL

Fashion brands enter through teamwear.



02 — MERCHANDISING

Fans become consumers.



03 — DRIVER BRANDS

Drivers develop individual cultural identities.



04 — LUXURY PARTNERSHIPS

Luxury groups enter at a global level.



05 — CULTURAL MOMENTUM

F1 becomes part of fashion, entertainment and lifestyle culture.

THE RESULT

F1 → SPORT

becomes

F1 → MEDIA → CULTURE → FASHION → LUXURY





THE BIGGER LESSON

F1 demonstrates how a legacy sports property can become a fashion platform without changing its core product.

The cars still race.

What changed is everything built around the race:

Storytelling

Merchandising

Partnerships

Celebrity

Fashion

Luxury

Cultural positioning

KEY INSIGHT

**Fashion brands do not always need to create cultural relevance themselves.
They can attach themselves to an existing cultural movement and help
commercialise it.**

FROM MOTORSPORT TO CULTURAL PLATFORM

Formula 1's evolution into fashion was not driven by one partnership.

It was created through the accumulation of multiple cultural and commercial shifts:

New audiences

- Driver influence
- Fashion partnerships
- Luxury investment
- Entertainment culture



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**THANKYOU
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